

JAPAN REAL ESTATE EXPLORER

[Complete Data Catalog & API Reference](#)

All data sources, fields, coverage, and availability

[MLIT Real Estate Information Library API](#)

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Generated: May 2026

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1. MLIT XIT001 - Real Estate Transaction Prices

API Key: MLIT_API_KEY | Status: ACTIVE | Endpoint: reinfoib.mlit.go.jp/ex-api/external/XIT001

Source: Ministry of Land, Infrastructure, Transport and Tourism
Coverage: All 47 prefectures, any municipality. Data from 2005 Q3 to present (~2 quarter lag).
Auth: Header 'Ocp-Apim-Subscription-Key'. Params: year, quarter, area (pref code), language=en.
Note: One call per prefecture x quarter. Recommended rate: 0.4s between calls.

1a. ward_transactions.parquet - Tokyo 23 Wards (245,139 rows, 2020-2025)

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
ward	string	100%	Ward name in English (Chiyoda, Minato, etc.)
ward_ja	string	100%	Ward name in Japanese kanji
property_type	string	100%	Used Apartment / Used House / Used Commercial / Land Only
purpose	string	55.9%	Declared use: House, Office, Shop, Other
region	string	23.6%	Sub-zone within ward from MLIT record
tx_year	int	100%	Transaction year (2020-2025)
tx_quarter	int	100%	Transaction quarter (1-4)
tx_period	string	100%	Combined period label e.g. '2023-Q2'
area_m2	float	100%	Property floor area in square meters
layout	string	100%	Apartment layout: 1K, 1LDK, 2LDK, etc. '-' for land/commercial
year_built	int	90.6%	Year the building was constructed
building_age	int	90.6%	Age of building at time of transaction (years)
nearest_station	string	0%	Nearest station - NOT provided by MLIT XIT001
station_minutes	int	0%	Walk time to station - NOT provided by MLIT XIT001
trade_price_jpy	int	100%	Total transaction price in Japanese Yen
price_per_m2_jpy	int	100%	Price per square meter in Japanese Yen
lat	float	100%	Ward centroid latitude
lon	float	100%	Ward centroid longitude
district	string	100%	MLIT DistrictName - sub-ward neighborhood (e.g. Roppongi)
district_code	string	100%	JIS district code (9 digits)
structure	string	0%	Building structure: RC, SRC, Steel, Wood - NOT returned for Tokyo
direction	string	28.9%	Facade orientation: South, Southwest, East, etc.
renovation	string	31.3%	Renovation status: Done / Not Done
city_planning	string	96.2%	City planning zone: Residential / Commercial / Industrial
coverage_ratio	float	64.8%	Maximum building footprint as % of lot area
floor_area_ratio	float	64.8%	Maximum total floor area as % of lot area (FAR)
frontage_m	float	21.6%	Street frontage of the lot in meters
breadth_m	float	28.6%	Depth of the lot in meters

1b. prefecture_aggregates.parquet - 47 Prefectures (94 rows, 2024-2025)

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
prefecture_code	string	100%	2-digit prefecture code (01=Hokkaido ... 47=Okinawa)
tx_year	int	100%	Transaction year (2024 or 2025)
median_ppm2	float	100%	Median price per m2 across all transactions in that year
mean_ppm2	float	100%	Mean price per m2 (skewed by luxury outliers)
n_transactions	int	100%	Number of transactions used to compute the aggregate

1c. prefecture_aggregates_by_type.parquet - 47 Prefectures x Property Type (376 rows)

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
prefecture_code	string	100%	2-digit prefecture code
tx_year	int	100%	Transaction year (2024 or 2025)
property_type	string	100%	Used Apartment / Used House / Used Commercial / Land Only
median_ppm2	float	100%	Median price per m2 for that type in that year
n_transactions	int	100%	Transaction count for that type/year/prefecture

2. MLIT Other Endpoints - Available, Not Yet Fetched

Same MLIT_API_KEY. All available today.

XCT001 - Appraised Property Valuations | Period: Last 5 years

Official government appraisals - more accurate than transaction prices for land valuation.

- Appraised value (JPY)
- Property type
- Land area (m2)
- Building area (m2)
- Year built
- Purpose
- Location (prefecture / municipality)
- Appraisal date

XPT001 - Transaction Prices - Point Data | Period: 2005 to present

Same as XIT001 but returns exact GPS coordinates - enables heatmaps at address level.

- Exact latitude / longitude per transaction
- Price (JPY)
- Area (m2)
- Property type
- Year
- Quarter

XPT002 - Published Land Prices - Point Data | Period: 1995 to present

Government benchmark land prices - published annually for key reference points nationwide.

- Exact latitude / longitude
- Published land price (JPY/m2)
- Year
- Land use category
- Building coverage ratio
- Floor area ratio

XKT002 - Land Use Zones | Period: Current

Zoning map for all of Japan. Shows what can be built where - critical for development potential.

- Zone type (Residential / Commercial / Industrial / Agricultural)
- Sub-category (e.g. Category 1 Low-rise Residential)
- Geometry (polygon GeoJSON)
- Municipality code

XKT015 - Station Boarding Statistics | Period: Latest available

Real passenger volume per station - replaces the synthetic station proximity factor in the price estimator.

- Station name
- Daily average boardings
- Railway line
- Municipality code
- Latitude / longitude

XKT016/021-029 - Disaster Risk Zones | Period: Current

Key differentiator for foreign investors unaware of Japan disaster risk geography.

- Risk type (flood / landslide / tsunami / liquefaction / embankment)
- Risk level (High / Medium / Low)
- Geometry (polygon GeoJSON)
- Municipality code

XKT001 - Urban Planning Areas | Period: Current

Whether an area is designated for development or restricted - affects future price appreciation.

- Planning area name
- Classification (Urbanization Promotion / Urbanization Control)
- Geometry
- Prefecture / municipality code

XIT002 - Municipal Codes Reference | Period: Current

Master reference table for all Japanese municipality codes.

- Municipality code (5 digits)
- Municipality name (EN/JA)
- Prefecture code
- Municipality type (city / town / village)

3. e-Stat - Government Statistics Portal

API Key: `ESTAT_API_KEY` | Status: `KEY OBTAINED, NOT YET FETCHED` | `api.e-stat.go.jp`

Source: Ministry of Internal Affairs and Communications

Endpoint: `https://api.e-stat.go.jp/rest/3.0/app/json/getStatsData`

Auth: appld query parameter. Free, no rate limit specified.

Population Census 2020 | Dataset: 0004019304 | Geography: 47 prefectures

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
<code>prefecture_code</code>	string	100%	2-digit code
<code>sex</code>	string	100%	Total / Male / Female
<code>age_group</code>	string	100%	5-year age groups (0-4, 5-9, ... 85+)
<code>population</code>	int	100%	Number of persons
<code>year</code>	int	100%	2020

Housing Survey 2023 - Vacant Dwellings (Akiya) | Dataset: 0004021648 | 47 prefectures

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
<code>prefecture_code</code>	string	100%	2-digit code
<code>vacancy_type</code>	string	100%	For sale / For rent / Secondary / Other vacant / Total
<code>n_dwellings</code>	int	100%	Number of vacant dwellings
<code>vacancy_rate</code>	float	100%	Vacant dwellings as % of total dwelling stock
<code>year</code>	int	100%	2023

Housing Survey 2023 - Dwelling Size | Dataset: 0004021461 | 47 prefectures

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
<code>prefecture_code</code>	string	100%	2-digit code
<code>tenure_type</code>	string	100%	Owner-occupied / Rented
<code>avg_floor_area_m2</code>	float	100%	Average floor area per dwelling in m2
<code>avg_rooms</code>	float	100%	Average number of rooms per dwelling
<code>year</code>	int	100%	2023

Housing Survey 2023 - Tenure | Dataset: 0004021624 | 47 prefectures

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
<code>prefecture_code</code>	string	100%	2-digit code
<code>tenure_type</code>	string	100%	Owner-occupied / Rented private / Public rental / Company housing
<code>n_dwellings</code>	int	100%	Number of dwellings by tenure type
<code>share_pct</code>	float	100%	Share of total dwelling stock (%)
<code>year</code>	int	100%	2023

Housing Survey 2023 - Elderly Households | Dataset: 0004025672 | 47 prefectures

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
<code>prefecture_code</code>	string	100%	2-digit code
<code>household_type</code>	string	100%	Single elderly / Couple both 65+ / With younger members
<code>n_households</code>	int	100%	Number of households
<code>barrier_free_pct</code>	float	100%	Share of dwellings with barrier-free features (%)
<code>year</code>	int	100%	2023

Census 2020 - Employment by Industry Dataset: 0003454502 47 prefectures			
Field	Type	Coverage	Description
prefecture_code	string	100%	2-digit code
industry	string	100%	Industry category (17 groups): Manufacturing, Finance, IT, etc.
employed_persons	int	100%	Number of employed persons aged 15+
year	int	100%	2020

4. Static / Hardcoded Data (Remaining)

Still in code. Population and akiya to be replaced by e-Stat.

prefecture_data.py - Remaining hardcoded fields

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
name_en / name_ja	string	100%	Prefecture name EN/JA - geographic constant, OK to keep
capital	string	100%	Capital city name - geographic constant, OK to keep
region	string	100%	Region grouping (Kanto, Kansai...) - OK to keep
lat / lon	float	100%	Centroid coordinates - geographic constant, OK to keep
is_major_metro	bool	100%	Major metro flag - classification constant, OK to keep
pop_2020	float	100%	Population - REPLACE with e-Stat Census 2020
pop_2010	float	100%	Population 2010 - not in e-Stat API; keep or drop
pop_change_pct	float	100%	Derived from pop_2010/2020 - recalculate from e-Stat
akiya_rate_2023	float	100%	Vacancy rate 2023 - REPLACE with e-Stat Housing Survey
akiya_rate_2018	float	100%	Vacancy rate 2018 - not in e-Stat API; keep or drop
akiya_rate_2013	float	100%	Vacancy rate 2013 - not in e-Stat API; keep or drop

ward_data.py - Remaining hardcoded fields

Field	Type	Coverage	Description
ja	string	100%	Ward name in Japanese - geographic constant, OK to keep
lat / lon	float	100%	Ward centroid coordinates - geographic constant, OK to keep
pop	int	100%	Ward population in thousands - could replace with e-Stat municipal
base_price	int	100%	Base price/m2 estimate - SUPERSEDED by real ward_transactions.parquet
activity	float	100%	Transaction volume weight - SUPERSEDED by real ward_transactions.parquet

Note: base_price and activity in ward_data.py are now dead code since load_data() uses the real parquet. They can be safely deleted.

5. Additional Sources - Roadmap

Not yet integrated. All free.

Bank of Japan API - free, no key | Period: macroeconomics.boj.or.jp

Interest rate history (policy rate, mortgage rates). Explains price cycles - rates near 0 since 1999 drove the appreciation seen in XIT001 data.

- Date
- Policy rate (%)
- 10-year JGB yield (%)
- Average mortgage rate (%)

ExchangeRate-API - free tier | Period: exchangerate-api.com

USD/JPY, EUR/JPY, AUD/JPY rates. Critical for foreign investor audience - all prices should optionally show USD equivalent.

- Date
- USD/JPY
- EUR/JPY
- AUD/JPY
- GBP/JPY
- CNY/JPY

MLIT XKT015 - Station Boarding Stats - MLIT key (have it) | Period: reinfo.lib.mlit.go.jp

Real daily passenger volume per station. Replaces synthetic station_minutes factor in price estimator.

- Station name
- Railway line
- Daily boardings
- Lat/Lon
- Municipality code

MLIT Disaster Risk XKT016/021-029 - MLIT key (have it) | Period: reinfo.lib.mlit.go.jp

Flood, tsunami, liquefaction, landslide risk zones as GeoJSON polygons. Strong differentiator for investors.

- Risk type
- Risk level (High/Med/Low)
- Polygon geometry
- Municipality

OpenStreetMap Overpass API - free, no key | Period: overpass-api.de

Points of interest: schools, hospitals, convenience stores, parks, supermarkets by ward. Enables amenity scoring.

- POI name
- Category
- Lat/Lon
- Ward / district

National Land Numerical Information - free, no key | Period: nlftp.mlit.go.jp

Land use rasters, elevation models, administrative boundaries. Enables terrain and land-use overlays.

- Land use category
- Elevation (m)
- Grid resolution (250m or 500m)